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STRENGTHENING HAWAII’S HOSPITALITY WORKFORCE THROUGH SHORT TERM PROGRAMS

Spring 2026 *Hānai I Ka 'Ipu* program for **The Kahala Hotel & Resort** integrating Hawaiian values, leadership development, cultural knowledge, and global sustainability practices.



“The Hawai‘i Place-Based Professional Development program demonstrates what is possible when industry and education work together with purpose. Through this partnership with Kapi‘olani Community College, our colleagues are strengthening their leadership skills, deepening their understanding of Hawai‘i’s cultural values, and delivering hospitality that reflects the true spirit of this place. This investment in people helps ensure that Hawai‘i’s hospitality workforce continues to grow with pride, purpose, and opportunity.”

Joe Ibarra, Vice President and General Manager, The Kāhala Hotel & Resort



“This class has been nothing but amazing! As a kānaka working in hospitality, this class has taught me more values that I can apply to myself in the food and beverage industry as well as eventually moving into the leadership level in the near future!”

Heuionalani Bandman, Employee, The Kāhala Hotel & Resort

GROUNDBREAKING CULINARY WORKFORCE & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT PROGRAMS

Fall 2024 to Spring 2026: 15 cohorts, 233 students, 95% fill rate
Culinary Institute of the Pacific (CIP)

“CIA/CIP really opened opportunities for my culinary career. People saw my journey through the glass and offered me consulting jobs and even my own restaurant. I’ll be using knowledge from the class to create plant forward “Banchan” at my new spot, opening in a couple weeks.”

Chef Kale Afong, Food Influencer/ Entrepreneur



“Attending CIP Workforce Development strengthened my skills and transformed how I teach, lead teamwork, and create recipes. Using techniques from Pacific Rim Plant-Forward Cooking, I created a banana burger that won at Ka Ho‘olaule‘a Mai‘a Festival and continues showcasing Hawai‘i’s ingredients.”

Chef Mari Willis, Former Culinary Instructor at Kaiser High School , Kapi‘olani Community College Alum

